

Printing Press

The mechanism of the first printing press was invented by a goldsmith named Johannes Gutenberg around the year 1440 in Germany

Stop music sharing

Jammie Thomas-Rasset, a mother of four from Minnesota, has been put to trial and ordered to pay \$1.9 million in a case against her for violating music copyright laws as she was caught sharing 24 songs illegally

tones produced by the Pixma iP1980 and Pixma iP2680. Along with that, there was clear banding and pixellation visible. The first test image does not show the reflections in the water, or even the ripples of the water, clearly. Also the darker shades of black were merged towards the end of the greyscale chart.

The second test image gave a complete lack of reds and it was not able to give a good quality print. The third test image revealed the same blue tone over the entire image, though the black was reproduced better than the iP1980 and iP2680. Some brown colouration looked better in this image, but there was still loss of detail and pixellation all over the image. The Combi document print showed us that this printer was not able to reproduce reds correctly and the grey text was leaning towards green. Even so, the red cherries in the image, though rather pixellated,



Canon Pixma iX5000

were well differentiated and looked better, but this wasn't enough to ignore the other flaws we found in the quality of the prints.

The Canon Pixma iP4680 costs Rs. 8,155; this would be a decent price if the print quality were really good. But it is not, judging by the bad results we obtained. This is one printer that we cannot recommend you buy.

Canon Pixma iX5000

Another entry level printer from Canon, but this time around it is an entry level A3 photo printer. This is the only A3

HOW WE TESTED

We setup a test rig for this photo printer test as follows: CPU: Intel P4 @ 3.2 GHz, motherboard: ECS PF5 Extreme, memory: 2 GB of DDR2 memory running at 800 MHz, graphics card: Nvidia 7300 LE, monitor: 17 inch LG Studioworks 700E. The photo paper used was Compu Color's Premium Gloss Photo paper, which is 130 GSM paper.

We calibrated the LG monitor using the Spyder3Elite so that we could compare the print-outs to the test images as closely as possible. We used a total of three test images and one PDF document.

The first test image is a compilation of images which include a green scene with

a pond and a house, with reflections of the house in the water and ripples on the pond. This can give us a good idea of how well greens are reproduced and also how some nice details are printed. There is also a scene with buildings which is used to spot the name of a shop. There is also a greyscale chart and a sharpness test included in this image.

The second test image we used is a photograph shot by Manas Parekh, our photographer. This photo depicts a glass of cognac; this includes some fine details, and also enables us to judge how well the printers are able to recreate the more subtle tones

in this image.

The third test image is another mix of many small scenes; these include a wide range of colours, many details and skin tones.

In each test we also made a printout of our Combi.pdf document; this is a combination of text and images and the intention here is to judge the quality of the printed text.

All the images were studied under a magnifying glass in daylight in order judge which one of the printers gave us the best results.

The time taken to print the images in best quality as well as in the fastest quality or eco-mode was also recorded.

photo printer we received for our test, but we followed the same procedures and testing as with the rest of the printers, using A4-size paper only.

This printer will need some desk space especially with a width of 23.6-inches. It looks pretty simple before the covers have been opened, but the rugged looks begin to show when you lift the paper loading and receiving trays. It has a very angular design, with no smooth edges. The buttons are located, facing the front. Canon has stuck with the no display and two button approach with the iX5000 as well; one button for power and the other to clear paper jams. The USB PictBridge port is located below the buttons and allows you to print straight from a compatible digital camera without the need to connect it to a computer.

Paper is loaded through the rear tray and this Pixma can hold up to 150 sheets of plain A4 paper. The rear portion can be extended and unfolded to quite a height as it has to give support for A3 paper, the same is the case with the paper out tray which can be extended to hold A3 paper. The process

of using this extension is not too smooth and the tray feels wobbly.

The Pixma iX5000 uses four print cartridges, each for the CMYK colours, and installing them is quite easy with a simple clip mechanism.

The printer also reproduced our test images with a warmer tone, similar to the iP1980 and iP2680 but not as strongly. In the first test image, there was some loss of detail, but there was no banding. The image did not show clusters of pixels as was seen with the others. Also the darker shades of black were merged.

The second test image



Canon Pixma iX5000

was clear, but wasn't able to reproduce some dark shades correctly. The third image was also on the warmer side, and did not reproduce black correctly. The purple pebbles present in one scene, though differentiated, were printed out with a darker shade. There was some detail loss but not as

much as with Canon's iP1980, iP2680 and iP4680.

You do not expect to move an A3 printer frequently, but once it is set, there should be no problem; the PictBridge is an added bonus, but like the other Canon Printers, a display would have certainly benefited this printer. Paying Rs. 18,995 for the Canon Pixma iX5000 would make sense for a SoHo print media workplace, certainly if you are on a budget and can't spend too much.

Canon Pixma iP100

There were mixed opinions regarding the Canon Pixma iP100: whether it should be in the general category of photo printers or it should be considered a compact photo printer. In the end, we decided that this should be included as a general photo printer, due to the fact that it can print sheets in A4 size.

The Canon Pixma iP100 is a portable photo printer, it has a very thin and stylish form factor, which lead us to consider that it was a compact photo printer. The silver exteriors with smooth edges really add to the printer's sleek look. The main reason this printer is a portable printer is not that it has a carry handle, but that Canon has also provided an attachable